

Policy Title: Sports Accommodation Policy

Document Information

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Owner	Office of Academic Affairs

Version History

Version	Approved By	Approval Date	Effective Date
1			

Need for Policy

1. Formalize the process for availing academic accommodation for sportspersons who represent Ashoka University
2. Request faculty to announce an accommodation policy in their syllabus

Attachments

1. Proposed Policy

Existing informal policy as stated in undergraduate handbook

(UG Handbook 2024, Pg. 21)

Students who represent Ashoka in any capacity (e.g., as athletes or artists in competition or for extracurricular and interuniversity events on and off-campus) must route their request for absences through the appropriate channels. Athletes write to sports@ashoka.edu.in; other students, groups, clubs, and societies send an email to the Office of Student Life, giving the details of the event with the date, the name of the professor, and course details. Such requests must be submitted way ahead of the event, ideally about two weeks earlier. While they are encouraged to support students who represent Ashoka (up to a maximum of four absences) by excusing them, the final decision regarding the handling of such absences lies with individual faculty members. Students are, in turn, advised to use their three excused absences for such events, wherever possible.

Proposed policy

Sports Accommodation Policy

Ashoka University Office of Academic Affairs

Ashoka University values the active participation of its students in extracurricular activities, competitions, and events that enhance personal growth and promote the university's reputation. It understands that student sports-persons may on rare occasions need to be absent from classes while representing the university. To ensure that absences for this reason can be accommodated without excessive penalty for legitimate absence while also satisfying academic requirements, student sports-persons applying for accommodation are required to adhere to the following rules:

1. A request for accommodation should be made at least two weeks in advance, to the Department of Sports of the Office of Student Life. It must then be verified by them and passed on to the Director of the Office of Academic Affairs (OAA), who is also the Nodal Officer for Accommodations, at least one week before the absence for which accommodation is sought.
2. Under normal circumstances, accommodations will be granted only for inter-college sports festivals, all-India inter-university events, zonal, state-level, and all-India events, international tournaments, and open invitational tournaments (including marathons). Exceptions may be made under special circumstances by the Dean of Academic Affairs, on the recommendation of the Sports Department.
3. The Director of the OAA will verify that the applicant has a current CGPA of at least 2.5. Applicants who do not satisfy this condition will not normally be eligible for sports-related accommodations. Exceptions may be granted by the Dean of Academic Affairs.
4. A sports-person representing the university may be granted a maximum of three additional excused absences for the purposes of representing the university over and above the three excused absences allowed to all students.

5. Once an accommodation request is approved by the Director of the OAA, they will communicate it to the instructors of the courses in which the applicant is enrolled.
6. Accommodation for missed classes may involve mandatory office hours for the student. This will be decided by the instructor of the course.
7. No accommodation will normally be made for the major assessment component of the course, which may be a final exam or a final submission. Exceptions to this may be granted by the instructor.
8. Accommodations for in-term tests and assignments are left to the discretion of the instructor. Two common methods are: (i) giving make-up tests or assignments, and (ii) shifting the weightage so that assessment components for which the student is present carry more of the total weight. This is to be decided by the instructor. We recommend that the instructor state their individual policy on adjustment of assessment for sports-related accommodations in their syllabus.
9. No accommodation will normally be made for absence during pre-registration and registration.